

SENATE No. 2688

Senate, October 30, 2025 -- Resolutions adopted by the Senate calling on the President of the United States to release contingency funds for the supplemental nutrition assistance program for the duration of the ongoing federal government shutdown (being the text of Senate, No. 2686, printed as amended)

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

RESOLUTIONS CALLING ON THE PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES TO RELEASE CONTINGENCY FUNDS FOR THE SUPPLEMENTAL NUTRITION ASSISTANCE PROGRAM FOR THE DURATION OF THE ONGOING FEDERAL GOVERNMENT SHUTDOWN.

1 WHEREAS, THE SUPPLEMENTAL NUTRITION ASSISTANCE PROGRAM IS 1 OF
2 THE NATION’S MOST EFFECTIVE AND EFFICIENT FOOD SECURITY PROGRAMS,
3 PROVIDING CRITICAL SUPPORT TO MORE THAN 40 MILLION UNITED STATES
4 RESIDENTS, INCLUDING 1 MILLION RESIDENTS OF THE COMMONWEALTH; AND

5 WHEREAS, ANY DISRUPTION IN SUPPLEMENTAL NUTRITION ASSISTANCE
6 PROGRAM BENEFITS, EVEN BRIEF, WOULD THREATEN THE FOOD SECURITY AND
7 WELL-BEING OF RESIDENTS OF THE COMMONWEALTH, DISPROPORTIONATELY
8 BURDENING SENIORS, CHILDREN AND INDIVIDUALS LIVING WITH DISABILITIES;
9 AND

10 WHEREAS, MORE THAN 5,500 RETAILERS IN THE COMMONWEALTH
11 PARTICIPATE IN THE SUPPLEMENTAL NUTRITION ASSISTANCE PROGRAM, WITH
12 PURCHASES ACCOUNTING FOR UP TO 20 PER CENT OF ALL GROCERY SPENDING

13 IN SOME STORES, SUCH THAT AN INTERRUPTION IN BENEFITS WOULD
14 DESTABILIZE LOCAL GROCERS, UNDERMINE JOBS AND CAUSE CASCADING
15 HARM TO FARMERS, FISHERS AND FOOD PRODUCERS; AND

16 WHEREAS, EMERGENCY FOOD PROVIDERS ACROSS THE COMMONWEALTH
17 HAVE ALREADY REPORTED SHARP INCREASES IN DEMAND AND WHILE THE
18 LEGISLATURE AND ADMINISTRATION HAVE EXPANDED INVESTMENTS IN STATE-
19 BASED ANTI-HUNGER INITIATIVES, INCLUDING THE MASSACHUSETTS
20 EMERGENCY FOOD ASSISTANCE PROGRAM, UNIVERSAL SCHOOL MEALS AND
21 THE HEALTHY INCENTIVES PROGRAM, THE COMMONWEALTH CANNOT ABSORB
22 THE \$210,000,000 PER MONTH IN FEDERAL SUPPLEMENTAL NUTRITION
23 ASSISTANCE PROGRAM PAYMENTS THAT WOULD BE LOST IF NOT FUNDED
24 DURING THE ONGOING FEDERAL GOVERNMENT SHUTDOWN; AND

25 WHEREAS, FOR EVERY 1 MEAL PROVIDED BY A FOOD BANK, THE
26 SUPPLEMENTAL NUTRITION ASSISTANCE PROGRAM PROVIDES 9 MEALS,
27 UNDERSCORING THE IRREPLACEABLE ROLE OF FEDERAL SUPPORT IN
28 PREVENTING HUNGER AND HARDSHIP; NOW, THEREFORE BE IT

29 RESOLVED, THAT THE MASSACHUSETTS SENATE HEREBY URGES THE
30 PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES TO USE ALL EXISTING AUTHORITY TO
31 SUPPLEMENT AND TRANSFER AVAILABLE FUNDS TO SUSTAIN SUPPLEMENTAL
32 NUTRITION ASSISTANCE PROGRAM BENEFITS THROUGHOUT THE DURATION OF
33 THE ONGOING FEDERAL GOVERNMENT SHUTDOWN; AND BE IT FURTHER

34 RESOLVED, THAT THE MASSACHUSETTS SENATE CALLS UPON THE
35 MASSACHUSETTS CONGRESSIONAL DELEGATION TO ADVOCATE FOR AND
36 SUPPORT IMMEDIATE FEDERAL ACTION TO ENSURE THE CONTINUATION OF
37 SUPPLEMENTAL NUTRITION ASSISTANCE PROGRAM BENEFITS; AND BE IT
38 FURTHER

39 RESOLVED, THAT COPIES OF THESE RESOLUTIONS BE TRANSMITTED
40 FORTHWITH BY THE CLERK OF THE SENATE TO THE PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED
41 STATES AND TO EACH MEMBER OF THE MASSACHUSETTS CONGRESSIONAL
42 DELEGATION.

SUBMITTED BY:

SENATOR

SENATE COSPONSORS:

SENATOR RODRIGUES